Universal Human Values – II (UHV-II)

Module 1 · Session 2 — Student Activity Worksheet

Lecture 2 — Understanding Value Education

Session	2	**Lecture**	Lecture 2
Topic	Understanding Value Education (value, human values, guidelines, content and process of value education)		
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Session Learning Outcomes

By the end of this session, the student should be able to:

- Explain that the value of a unit is its participation in the larger order.
- State and apply the four guidelines for value education.
- Distinguish between values and skills and their priority.

How to Engage with this Session (The Process)

- Whatever is said is a proposal — do not assume it to be true or false.
- Verify it on your own right, on the basis of your natural acceptance.
- It is a dialogue: first with the teacher, then within your own self — between what you are and what you really want to be.

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap)

- The value (role) of a unit is its participation in the larger order, and it is definite.
- For a human being to live with human values, s/he has to understand them; living with human values leads to mutual happiness (with humans) and mutual prosperity (with nature).
- Four guidelines for value education: universal, rational, verifiable, and leading to harmony.
- Content of value education is holistic — four levels (individual, family, society, nature/existence) and four dimensions (understanding, thought, behaviour, work).
- Values (what to do) come first, then skills (how to do); both are complementary. Present education has become skill-biased.

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Value = Participation in the Larger Order

For each unit, write the larger order it participates in and its value (role).

Unit	Larger order	Value / role
Wheat	Nature / food chain	Provides food and nutrition
A piece of chalk	Education / classroom	Helps in teaching and communication
Myself (as a member of my family)	Family	Contribute through respect, care, trust, affection and responsibility

Activity 2 — Values or Skills?

Mark each item: is it about WHAT to do (value) or HOW to do (skill)?

Item	What to do (Value) / How to do (Skill)
Deciding to behave with respect in the family	Value
Learning to operate a machine	Skill
Deciding to utilise resources rightly	Value
Coding / drafting / welding technique	Skill

Are the problems around you more due to lack of skills or lack of values? Which has priority?

Many problems are caused by a **lack of values**, even when people possess sufficient skills. Values have priority because they determine what a person should do, while skills determine how to do it. Both are necessary, but values should come first.

Activity 3 — Did You Decide Your Values?

List two values/habits you have adopted. For each, mark whether you decided it on your own right, or it was programmed by others (society, peers, etc.).

Value / habit adopted	Decided on my own right? / Programmed by others?
Respecting my parents	Decided on my own right after understanding its importance
Helping friends when they need support	Decided on my own right

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. “Value of a unit is its participation in the larger order.” Explain this statement with examples, and extend it to human values.

The value of a unit means the **role or participation of that unit in the larger order**. Every unit has a definite role and contributes to the functioning of the larger system.

For example:

- **Wheat** participates in the larger order of nature by providing food and nutrition to human beings and animals.
- **A piece of chalk** participates in the larger order of education by helping a teacher communicate knowledge to students.
- **A human being as a member of a family** participates in the family by contributing through relationships such as trust, respect, affection, care and responsibility.

In the case of human beings, understanding one's participation in the larger order leads to **human values**. A person who understands human values behaves in a way that creates **mutual happiness with other human beings and mutual prosperity with nature**. Thus, human values help us live harmoniously with ourselves, our family, society and nature.

Q2. State and explain the four guidelines for value education.

The four guidelines for value education are:

1. **Universal** – Value education should be applicable to all human beings, irrespective of caste, religion, gender, region or culture.
2. **Rational** – The values should be based on reasoning and understanding rather than blind belief or assumptions.
3. **Verifiable** – The proposals of value education should be personally verified by the individual through one's own understanding and natural acceptance.
4. **Leading to Harmony** – Value education should help a person develop harmony within oneself, with family and society, and with nature/existence.

Therefore, value education should not simply be accepted blindly. Whatever is presented should be considered as a proposal and verified on one's own right through natural acceptance.

Q3. Distinguish between values and skills. Explain their priority and complementarity, and comment on the present state of education.

Values refer to **what to do**, whereas **skills** refer to **how to do it**.

Values	**Skills**
Concerned with what should be done	Concerned with how something should be done

Values	Skills
Guide our intention and decisions	Help us perform an activity effectively
Example: behaving respectfully in a family	Example: operating a machine
Example: using resources rightly	Example: coding, drafting or welding

Values have **priority over skills** because a person must first know what is right or valuable before deciding how to perform an action. However, values and skills are **complementary**. Values without skills may not be effectively implemented, while skills without appropriate values may be misused.

The present education system has become largely **skill-biased**, giving greater importance to technical and professional skills while insufficiently emphasizing values. A balanced education should therefore develop both **values (what to do)** and **skills (how to do)**.